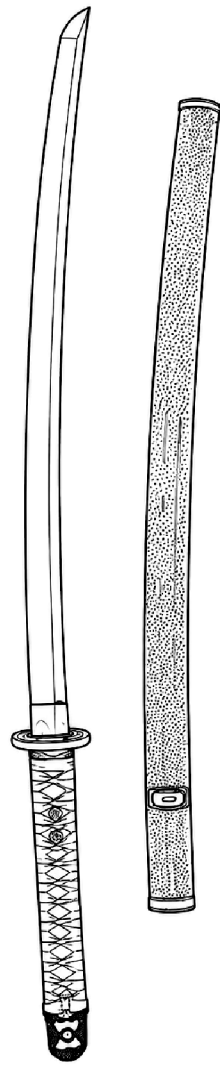

FREE GUIDE 01

A Daily Practice

Strength in the body. Clarity in
the mind. Steadiness in the
spirit.

JUSTIN MARTIN · THE STILL EDGE



Move through life with intention.

The Still Edge is a modern practice for developing strength, focus, and resilience in a distracted world.

Drawing from martial arts, breathwork, mobility training, meditation, and daily ritual, it provides a practical path for improving both physical and mental well-being. You do not need to be a martial artist to benefit from the principles taught here. The methods are designed for anyone seeking greater health, clarity, discipline, and purpose in daily life.

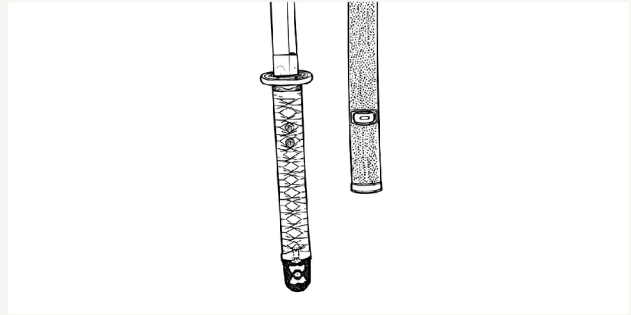
Modern life often leaves us exhausted, overstimulated, and disconnected from ourselves. We spend our days sitting, scrolling, reacting, and rushing from one obligation to the next. The Still Edge offers an alternative. Through simple, consistent practices, you learn to move better, breathe more effectively, reduce stress, improve focus, build physical capability, and develop a greater sense of calm and control.

The goal is not perfection. The goal is progress.

At its core, The Still Edge is about cultivating the qualities that help us thrive: strength without aggression, confidence without arrogance, discipline without rigidity, and calm without passivity. Whether your goal is to improve your health, sharpen your mind, age with vitality, manage stress, or simply create a more intentional life, small actions practiced consistently create profound change over time.

A note from Justin

I have spent most of my life studying movement, martial arts, and the pursuit of personal growth. As a Master Instructor of Han Mu Do, certified personal trainer, archery coach, husband, father, and business owner, I have seen firsthand how consistent practice can transform a person's life—and what it feels like to lose our way.



Sword study · Jeju, Korea

Martial arts taught me that strength is not just physical. True strength is the ability to remain calm in difficult moments, maintain discipline when motivation fades, and continue moving forward when life becomes challenging. The lessons I learned through training extend far beyond the *도장* *dojang*. They apply to our work, relationships, health, and the way we show up in the world every day.

No special equipment.

No previous experience.

Only a willingness to practice.

The Five Pillars



These are not steps to complete or levels to achieve. They are principles to return to each day.

— Breath

Breath is the bridge between body and mind. Through intentional breathing, we learn to regulate the nervous system, improve awareness, build a stronger fitness base, and create a foundation for calm action.

- Am I breathing with awareness?
- Can I remain calm under pressure?
- Am I controlling my breath, or is it controlling me?



Temple study · Korea

Practice

Growth does not come from intensity alone. It comes from consistency.

Small efforts performed regularly create lasting change. The goal is showing up.

- Did I show up today?
- Am I building habits that support my goals?
- What seeds am I planting through my daily actions?

Movement

Movement is how we express ourselves and interact with the world.

Stepping patterns, bodyweight exercises, mobility work, and form practice teach us to move with greater awareness and purpose.

- Am I moving with purpose?

- Is my posture supporting my health?
 - Am I becoming more capable and resilient?
-



Focus

Where attention goes, energy follows. Through meditation, breathwork, forms, and deliberate practice, we strengthen our ability to direct the mind intentionally.

- What deserves my attention today?
 - Am I present in what I am doing?
 - Can I remain centered when distractions arise?
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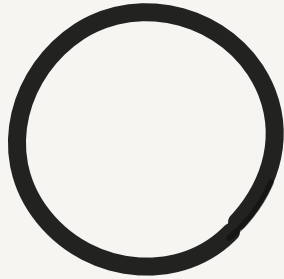


Purpose

Purpose gives direction to our efforts. When our actions connect to a meaningful purpose, discipline becomes easier and challenges become more manageable.

- What am I working toward?
 - Do my daily actions support my values?
 - Who am I becoming through my practice?
-

The Daily Return



One of the reasons I chose the word *practice* is because it removes the idea that we are ever finished.

There is no final destination. Life continues to change. Our bodies change. Our responsibilities change. Some seasons feel strong and productive, while others feel challenging and uncertain. The answer is not to constantly search for a new system. The answer is to return to the fundamentals.

The word *return* carries two meanings. First, it reminds us to return to the practice itself each day. We return to our breath before stress takes over. We move our bodies before

the stiffness of a sedentary and distracted world settles in. We focus our attention on what matters most, and reconnect with our purpose and the person we are trying to become.

Breathe	Move
Practice	Focus
Remember	Begin again

The second meaning is equally important. Over time, we receive a return on the investment we are making in ourselves. A few minutes of movement each morning may not seem significant. A breathing exercise may not immediately change our lives. A single walk through the garden may feel small and ordinary. But practice has a compounding effect.

Days become weeks.
Weeks become months.
Months become years.

The return reveals itself through a stronger body, a calmer mind, greater resilience, improved focus, and a clearer sense of purpose. Some days your practice may last an hour. Some days it may only be ten minutes. There will be days when you feel strong and energized and days when you feel tired and distracted. Both are part of the process.

The goal is not to create a flawless streak that never gets interrupted. It is to build a rhythm that can support you throughout your life. Eventually, you stop feeling like you are adding another task to your day. The practice simply becomes part of who you are.



Discipline in form



Temple path · Korea

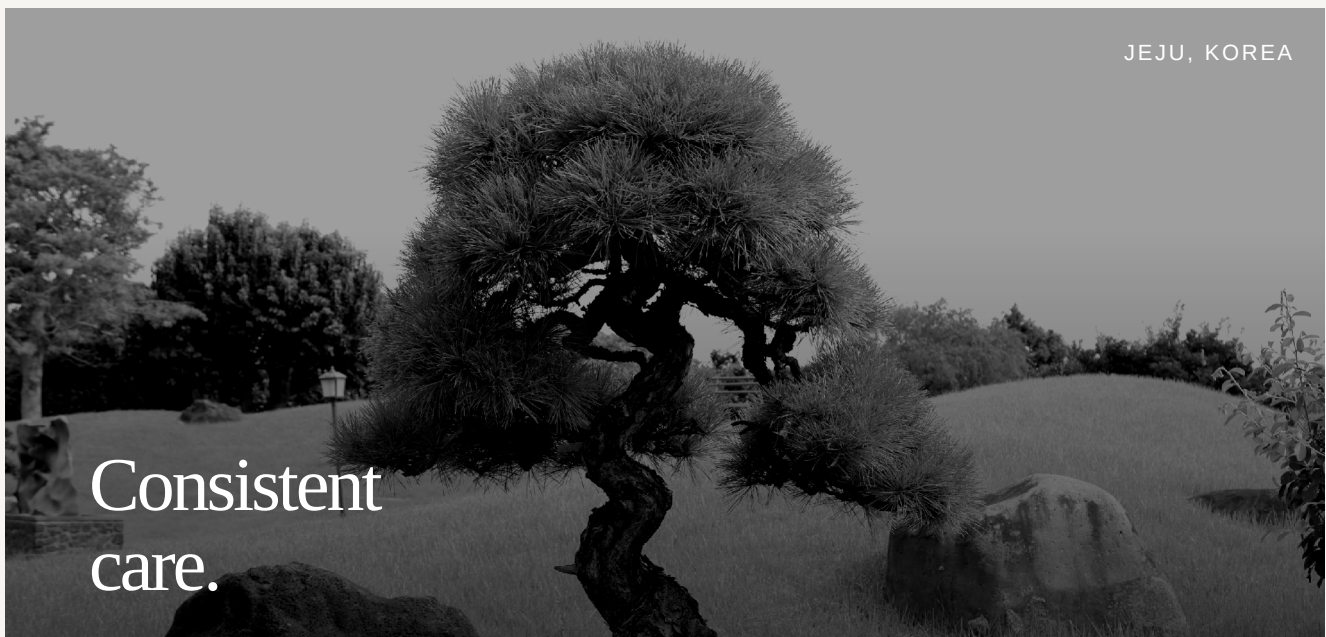
Morning Ritual

The morning is one of the few times in the day when the world is still quiet.

Before work, family responsibilities, and the countless demands of the day begin competing for my attention, there is a brief window where I can focus on preparing myself. As a coach, instructor, husband, father, and business owner, much of my day is spent serving others. The morning gives me an opportunity to invest in myself first so I can better serve the people around me later.

My routine is not complicated, and I do not believe it needs to be. Most mornings begin with a walk down the hallway and a fresh pot of coffee. While it brews, I spend a few minutes getting my body moving: chest openers, Hindu squats, pushups, crunches, and cowboy crunches.

I am not trying to set personal records or exhaust myself. The purpose is simply to wake the body up and assess where I am for the day. Some mornings I feel strong and energetic. Other mornings I feel stiff, sore, or tired. These are useful pieces of information. The body is constantly giving us feedback if we are willing to pay attention.





Attention.
Patience.

Move from body to breath.

After calisthenics, I move into breathing practice. In Han Mu Do, we often refer to this as Ki Breathing or accumulation, while other traditions may call it qigong. Regardless of the name, the simple act of slowing down and paying attention to the breath has tremendous value. As the breathing becomes smoother and more controlled, my thoughts tend to settle as well.

From there I move into form practice. This may be a Han Mu Do hyung, a sword form, or whatever sequence I am currently studying. Forms reveal something different every day. Some days my balance feels excellent. Other days I notice stiffness in my hips or tension in my shoulders. Some mornings my mind is focused and present. Others, I discover that I am distracted before I begin.

Let the quiet continue.

By the time I finish, the coffee is usually ready. I enjoy reading, writing, journaling, or simply thinking. If my schedule allows, I also spend time in the garden. Gardening reminds me of lessons that are easy to forget.

Growth takes time.

Plants do not grow because we demand it. They grow because they receive consistent care, attention, and patience. The same is true for people. Whether we are developing strength, learning a skill, improving our relationships, or working toward a goal, meaningful growth rarely happens overnight.

Start small.

The purpose of a morning ritual is not to prove how tough you are. It is to wake up your body, clear your mind, and prepare yourself for the day ahead.

01 **Choose a movement.**

Five pushups, ten squats, stretching, or a brisk walk around the block.

02 **Make it repeatable.**

Select something you can realistically do even when you are sore, tired, or busy.

03 **Leave room to be human.**

Do not demand seven perfect days. If you miss one, return the next morning.

Over time, what began as discipline becomes a habit. What began as effort begins to feel natural. Remember, the goal is not perfection. The goal is to build a practice that supports your life for years to come.

The Law of Practice



Meaningful progress rarely happens all at once.

A single workout changes very little. A single breathing exercise changes very little. A single morning ritual changes very little. What creates change is the accumulation of those efforts over time.

The same principle can be observed almost everywhere in life. A garden is not created in a day. It is built through consistent care. Seeds are planted, watered, protected, and given time to grow. Day to day, the changes may seem small. Over weeks and months, the results become obvious.



4096 layers · the discipline of craft · Korea

Practice is not about perfection.
Practice is the willingness to return.

Some days you will feel strong and motivated. Other days you will feel tired, distracted, or discouraged. The goal is not to perform perfectly on either of those days. The goal is simply to continue showing up.

Over time, breathing becomes more natural. Movement becomes more fluid. Focus becomes stronger. Healthy habits become easier to maintain. What once required effort gradually becomes part of who you are.

There is no finish line.

There is only the next breath, the next repetition, the next morning, and the next opportunity to begin again. Meaningful change is rarely dramatic. More often, it is found in ordinary moments repeated consistently over time.

It is found in the decision to take a walk when you would rather remain seated. It is found in a few minutes of breathing before reacting to a stressful situation. It is found in showing up to practice when motivation is low. It is found in choosing to begin again after a difficult day.

The qualities many of us desire—strength, confidence, resilience, patience, discipline, and peace of mind—are cultivated through ordinary actions practiced consistently over long periods of time.

Choose one practice that resonates with you and begin there. Spend a few minutes moving your body. Take a quiet walk. Practice a breathing exercise. Sit with a cup of coffee and watch the sunrise. Start a small garden. Read a few pages from a good book. Whatever you choose, approach it with consistency rather than intensity.

Keep practicing.

JUSTIN MARTIN

Photography from Jeju, Seoul, and other locations in Korea. Text adapted from the original *The Still Edge — A Daily Practice* manuscript.